The Ising perceptron at nonzero margin: certified bounds along the capacity curve

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November 2026

Abstract

The storage capacity of the Ising perceptron at margin κ is predicted by a replica-symmetric variational problem. Huang proved that the predicted threshold $\alpha_\star(\kappa)$ is an upper bound at every margin where four conditions on low-dimensional problems hold. We verify the four conditions in ball arithmetic at $\kappa = -0.45$, -0.05, 0.05, 0.0995 and 0.13, so the bound holds there unconditionally; at $\kappa = 0.05$ the capacity is at most $\alpha_\star(0.05) \in [0.781073068, 0.781074776]$. The fixed-point, message-passing and local-concavity conditions hold on the strip $\kappa \in [-0.65, 0.19]$. At $\kappa \neq 0$ the fixed point of the replica-symmetric equations is known only to a box about $8 \cdot 10^3$ times wider in one coordinate than at zero margin, and the zero-margin proof of Huang's two-variable condition fails at that width. It is restored by computing the moments of the maximizer as functions of the box, and by writing each difference of log-partition values that the proof needs as a single expectation expanded about the maximizer. Whether $\alpha_\star(\kappa)$ is also a lower bound at $\kappa \neq 0$ is open.

Keywords: binary perceptron, storage capacity, replica-symmetric formula, computer-assisted proof, ball arithmetic.
2020 Mathematics Subject Classification: 82B44, 60G15, 65G30.

1 Introduction

Store $m = \alpha N$ random patterns in a linear classifier with binary weights: for i.i.d. standard Gaussian vectors $g_1, \dots, g_m$ in $\mathbb{R}^N$ and a margin $\kappa \in \mathbb{R}$, ask whether some $w \in \{-1, +1\}^N$ satisfies

$$\frac{\langle g_a, w \rangle}{\sqrt{N}} \;\geq\; \kappa \qquad \text{for all } a \leq m.$$

Krauth and Mézard [1] computed the replica-symmetric prediction for the largest such α and conjectured it sharp; at $\kappa = 0$ their constant is $\alpha_\star = 0.8330786\ldots$, in the margin framework of Gardner and Derrida [3]. Rigorous bounds at zero margin go back to Kim and Roche [4] and Talagrand [5], who proved that the capacity is at most $1 - \varepsilon$ for some $\varepsilon > 0$; Altschuler and Tikhomirov [12] give a complete proof of the bound 0.847 outlined by Krauth and Mézard. Three decades later the zero-margin conjecture was resolved: Ding and Sun [9] proved the lower bound and Huang [10] the upper bound. Both proofs are conditional on numerical conditions about explicit low-dimensional variational problems, and those conditions are verified in interval arithmetic in [14], at $\kappa = 0$.

Huang's upper-bound theorem, however, is stated at every margin. For each κ it bounds the capacity by $\alpha_\star(\kappa)$, the root of the replica-symmetric free energy along its fixed-point branch, conditionally on four numerical conditions at that margin. The first asks that the fixed-point equations have a unique solution, along which the free energy changes sign. The second asks that the associated approximate-message-passing iteration be stable at that solution. The third asks that an explicit function of one real variable take a negative value at some point. The fourth asks that a function $\mathcal{S}_\star$ of two real variables be nonpositive on the whole plane (Conditions 1–4 of Section 2). Stojnic's fully-lifted random duality theory [21] predicts the same replica-symmetric values at every margin by nonrigorous means. We verify all four conditions at five nonzero margins.

Main Theorem (Theorem 4)**.** *For $\kappa \in \{-0.45,\ -0.05,\ 0.05,\ 0.0995,\ 0.13\}$ the four conditions of Huang's theorem hold, and the threshold $\alpha_\star(\kappa)$ lies in the interval*

$$\begin{aligned}
&\kappa = -0.45: \ [1.557652103,\ 1.557654133], \quad \kappa = -0.05: \ [0.889408031,\ 0.889409783],\\
&\kappa = 0.05: \ [0.781073068,\ 0.781074776], \quad \kappa = 0.0995: \ [0.733478513,\ 0.733480205],\\
&\kappa = 0.13: \ [0.705932217,\ 0.705933898].
\end{aligned}$$

For α above that interval, with probability $1 - o(1)$ as $N \to \infty$ no $w \in \{-1, +1\}^N$ satisfies all $\lceil \alpha N \rceil$ constraints.

At $\kappa = 0$ the four conditions are verified in [14]. There the fixed point (q_0, ψ_0) of the replica-symmetric equations (Section 2) is enclosed to width $8 \cdot 10^{-10}$ in q_0 and $1.2 \cdot 10^{-8}$ in ψ_0, so the moment point $a^\star = (\psi_0(1 - q_0), q_0)$ of the maximizing profile of Condition 4 can be treated as an exact point. The proof of Condition 4 works in the moment body K, the set of pairs $(\mathbb{E}[\dot{H}\Lambda], \mathbb{E}[M\Lambda])$ over functions Λ of $\dot{H}$ with $|\Lambda| \le 1$, where $\dot{H} \sim N(0, \psi_0)$ and $M = \tanh \dot{H}$. It bounds the entropy term by convex duality through the log-partition function $\Phi(b) = \mathbb{E} \log 2\cosh(b_1 \dot{H} + b_2 M)$, at dual points placed by certified sign tests; these need the signs of differences $\Phi(\lambda) - \Phi(\lambda') - (\lambda - \lambda') \cdot x$, $x \in K$, of order 10^{-7}.

At $\kappa \neq 0$ the threshold is enclosed in an interval, of width $1.7 \cdot 10^{-6}$ at $\kappa = 0.05$ (Theorem 4), a width set by the enclosure of the function G whose zero defines $\alpha_\star$ (Section 2) at the quadrature depth used ($1.4 \cdot 10^{-5}$ at the default depth), and the certificates must hold at every α of it. They are therefore run on the hull of the boxes that contain the fixed point at the two ends of the interval (Section 4). At $\kappa = 0.05$ this hull has width $1.5 \cdot 10^{-6}$ in q_0 and $9.2 \cdot 10^{-5}$ in ψ_0, about $2 \cdot 10^3$ and $8 \cdot 10^3$ times the widths at $\kappa = 0$; of the width in ψ_0, $2.4 \cdot 10^{-5}$ is the motion of the fixed point across the interval. On such a box each enclosure of Φ has width about $2 \cdot 10^{-5}$, and a box no wider than that motion still leaves $5 \cdot 10^{-6}$, so the sign tests of [14] are not decided and its argument does not apply as written.

Four changes make it apply on such boxes. First, $a^\star$ is never stored as a number. At the fixed point $\nabla\Phi(1, 0) = (\psi_0(1 - q_0), q_0)$, and the certificates use this pair and $s_0 = \sqrt{1 - q_0}$, the optimal value of the tilt s over which Huang's two-variable function is minimized (Section 5.2), as functions of the box; the identities at $a^\star$ are needed only at the true parameters, which lie in the box. Second, Φ is written against the point $b_0 = (1, 0)$ through the identity

$$\Phi(\lambda) - \Phi(b_0) - (\lambda - b_0) \cdot \nabla\Phi(b_0) = \mathbb{E}\big[\log\big(\cosh\Delta + M \sinh\Delta\big) - M\Delta\big], \qquad \Delta = (\lambda_1 - 1)\dot{H} + \lambda_2 M,$$

with $\nabla\Phi(b_0) = a^\star$ at the fixed point, so that the width of the box enters only at second order in $|\lambda - b_0|$; within distance 0.01 of b_0 the resulting enclosures are 50 to 160 times tighter than

differences of separate enclosures of Φ. Third, bounds on the inverse Mills ratio (Lemma 3) keep the second derivatives of the constraint term finite where the argument of the inverse Mills ratio is large. Fourth, the tilt along each ray from $a^\star$ moves with a slope fixed by the direction alone, one slope for each of 768 angular sectors, so that second-derivative bounds on successive radial bands chain along every ray.

With these changes the four certificates of [14] (a sweep of K away from $a^\star$; concavity along each ray from $a^\star$ up to a radius that depends on the direction, so on a star-shaped neighborhood of $a^\star$, the star; a second sweep of the gap between the star and the first sweep; and a certificate that the star lies inside K) hold at $\kappa = -0.45$, -0.05, 0.05, 0.0995 and 0.13 (Sections 5.2 and 6).

Conditions 1–3 hold on the whole strip $\kappa \in [-0.65, 0.19]$, on 1680 contiguous slabs of width $5 \cdot 10^{-4}$ (Section 4 and Theorem 5). The fixed point is unique because the derivative of $q \mapsto P(R(q,\alpha))$, the composition of the two fixed-point equations of Section 2, has a certified bound below 1: on each slab rectangle for $\kappa \in [-0.65, 0.10]$, and for $\kappa \in (0.10, 0.19]$ on narrower located rectangles (Section 4.3), where Nakajima's uniqueness theorem [13], whose premise is verified in ball arithmetic, gives uniqueness a second time. The Hessian at the maximizer $(1, 0)$ of the two-variable function with the tilt held at its optimal value, negative definite at $\kappa = 0$ by [10, Claim 2.6 and Appendix B.3], is negative definite at six margins (Section 5.1).

The strip uses the one-term formula for $\partial R/\partial q$ (Lemma 2), where $\psi = R(q,\alpha)$ is the second fixed-point equation. Lemma 1 is the computation of Ding and Sun [9, Lemma 7.1 and Corollary 7.2] carried out off the fixed-point branch, and Lemma 2 is Nakajima's formula [13, eq. (18)], rewritten for R; Nakajima states it for $\kappa \geq 0$, and the computation holds for every κ.

For $\kappa < 0$, Section 8 gives the lower bound $\max\{\alpha_\star(0), \alpha_c^{\mathrm{sym}}(|\kappa|)\}$, by monotonicity and by embedding a symmetric perceptron; it lies far below $\alpha_\star(\kappa)$. The enclosures of the special functions and the quadrature rules are those of [14].

Section 2 states the replica-symmetric system, Huang's four conditions and the two identities. Section 3 describes the capacity curve in floating point. Section 4 proves Conditions 1–3 on the strip, and Section 5 treats the two-variable function and its Hessian. Section 6 proves Condition 4 at the five margins and states Theorems 4 and 5; Section 7 records the further margins and explains why Condition 4 is proved at points and not on intervals of κ. Section 8 concerns the lower bound, Section 9 what is checked in exact arithmetic, Section 10 the reading of the curve for learning, and Section 11 further directions. The notation is collected at the end.

2 The system and the four conditions

Let φ and Ψ denote the standard Gaussian density and upper tail, $E = \varphi/\Psi$ the inverse Mills ratio (an increasing function; $E' = E\,(E - u) \in (0, 1)$, proved with its second-derivative bounds in Lemma 3), and $Z \sim N(0, 1)$. Fix $\kappa \in \mathbb{R}$ and write

$$u(z; q, \kappa) = \frac{\kappa - \sqrt{q}\, z}{\sqrt{1 - q}}, \qquad 0 < q < 1.$$

Following Ding–Sun and Huang, the replica-symmetric system is

$$P(\psi) = \mathbb{E}\big[\tanh^2(\sqrt{\psi}\,Z)\big], \qquad R(q,\alpha) = \frac{\alpha}{1-q}\,\mathbb{E}\big[E(u(Z))^2\big], \tag{1}$$

$$G(\alpha,q,\psi) = -\frac{\psi(1-q)}{2} + \mathbb{E}\log\big(2\cosh(\sqrt{\psi}\,Z)\big) + \alpha\,\mathbb{E}\log\Psi\big(u(Z)\big), \tag{2}$$

with the fixed-point branch $q = P(\psi)$, $\psi = R(q,\alpha)$ and the threshold $\alpha_\star(\kappa)$ defined as the zero of $G_\star(\alpha) = G(\alpha, q_\star(\alpha), \psi_\star(\alpha))$; we write $(q_0,\psi_0) = (q_\star,\psi_\star)(\alpha_\star(\kappa))$. At $\kappa = 0$, where $u = -\gamma z$ in law with $\gamma = \sqrt{q/(1-q)}$, this is the zero-margin system of [14]. (Display (14) of [10] has $-\alpha\,\mathbb{E}\log\Psi$; the fixed-point equations require the plus sign, which is the sign in [9, eq. (4)].)

Huang's theorem [10, Theorem 3.6] bounds the capacity at margin κ by $\alpha_\star(\kappa)$ subject to four numerical conditions, which we state in the form his proof uses; Conditions 1, 2, 3 and 4 below are his Conditions 3.1, 3.3, 3.4 and 1.3, the conditions of his Theorem 3.6.

Condition 1 (fixed point)**.** *There are an interval $[\alpha_-,\alpha_+]$ and a rectangle $[\alpha_-,\alpha_+]\times[q_{\mathrm{lb}},q_{\mathrm{ub}}]$ such that for every $\alpha\in[\alpha_-,\alpha_+]$ the map $q\mapsto P(R(q,\alpha))$ has a unique fixed point in $(q_{\mathrm{lb}},q_{\mathrm{ub}})$, with $\sup_{q\in(q_{\mathrm{lb}},q_{\mathrm{ub}})}(P\circ R_\alpha)'(q) < 1$, and $G_\star(\alpha) = G(\alpha,q_\star(\alpha),\psi_\star(\alpha))$, with $q_\star(\alpha)$ that fixed point and $\psi_\star(\alpha) = R(q_\star(\alpha),\alpha)$, is strictly decreasing on $[\alpha_-,\alpha_+]$ with a unique root there. Huang's $\kappa = 0$ instance (his Proposition 3.2) takes an interval of width 10^{-9} about the fixed point. We call the uniqueness and contraction part the rectangle clause.*

Condition 2 (approximate message passing, AMP)**.** *At the fixed point,*

$$\alpha\,\mathbb{E}[\mathrm{sech}^4(\sqrt{\psi_0}Z)]\;\frac{\mathbb{E}[E'(u(Z;q_0,\kappa))^2]}{(1-q_0)^2} \;<\; 1,$$

with $u(z;q,\kappa) = (\kappa - \sqrt{q}\,z)/\sqrt{1-q}$ as above.

Condition 3 (local concavity)**.** *Let $A = 1-q_0$, $F(x) = E\big((\kappa-x)/\sqrt{A}\big)/\sqrt{A}$, $\hat f_0 = -F'/(1+AF')$, $\mu(\hat z) = \mathbb{E}[(\hat z + \cosh^2(\sqrt{\psi_0}Z))^{-1}]$, $d_0 = \alpha_\star\mathbb{E}[F'(\sqrt{q_0}Z)]$ and*

$$\ell(\hat z) = \hat z - \alpha_\star\,\mathbb{E}\left[\frac{\hat f_0(\sqrt{q_0}Z)}{1+\mu(\hat z)\hat f_0(\sqrt{q_0}Z)}\right] - d_0, \qquad \hat z > -1.$$

Then $\ell(\hat z) < 0$ for some $\hat z > -1$.

This is [10, Condition 3.4], whose function is called λ there; a single witness suffices, since Huang's condition asks that $\inf_{\hat z>-1}\ell(\hat z) < 0$.

Condition 4 (two-variable function)**.** *$\mathcal{S}_\star(\lambda_1,\lambda_2) \le 0$ for all $(\lambda_1,\lambda_2)\in\mathbb{R}^2$, where $\mathcal{S}_\star$ is the two-variable function of Section 5.2; equality holds at $(1,0)$.*

2.1 Two identities

The function G is that of Ding and Sun [9, eq. (4)], who define it at general margin; the two lemmas below record its partial derivatives and the derivative of R at every κ.

Lemma 1 (stationarity)**.** *For all $\alpha > 0$, $\kappa\in\mathbb{R}$, $\psi > 0$ and $0 < q < 1$,*

$$\frac{\partial G}{\partial\psi} = \frac{q - P(\psi)}{2}, \qquad \frac{\partial G}{\partial q} = \frac{\psi - R(q,\alpha)}{2}.$$

In particular the critical points of G are exactly the solutions of Ding and Sun's fixed-point system $q = P(\psi)$, $\psi = R(q, \alpha)$ [9], at every margin.

Proof of Lemma 1. The first identity is Gaussian integration by parts on the $\log\cosh$ term. For the second, differentiating u in q gives

$$u_q = \frac{1}{2\sqrt{1-q}}\Big(-\frac{z}{\sqrt{q}} + \frac{u}{\sqrt{1-q}}\Big), \qquad \frac{\partial}{\partial q}\,\mathbb{E}\log\Psi(u) = -\mathbb{E}\big[E(u)\,u_q\big].$$

Stein's lemma applied to the z part, $\mathbb{E}[zE(u)] = -\sqrt{q/(1-q)}\;\mathbb{E}[E'(u)]$, together with the Mills identity $E'(u) = E(u)^2 - uE(u)$, collapses the two pieces:

$$\mathbb{E}[E(u)\,u_q] = \frac{\mathbb{E}[E'(u)] + \mathbb{E}[u\,E(u)]}{2(1-q)} = \frac{\mathbb{E}[E(u)^2]}{2(1-q)} = \frac{R(q,\alpha)}{2\alpha}.$$

Hence $\partial_q G = \psi/2 - \alpha \cdot R/(2\alpha) = (\psi - R)/2$. □

Both derivatives vanish exactly on the fixed-point branch. On a rectangle carrying the contraction of Condition 1 the branch $\alpha \mapsto (q_\star, \psi_\star)$ is C^1 (the implicit function theorem applies: $1-(P\circ R_\alpha)'$ is bounded away from zero), and the envelope theorem gives $G'_\star(\alpha) = \mathbb{E}\log\Psi(u) < 0$ strictly ($\Psi < 1$ pointwise), for every κ: the root $\alpha_\star(\kappa)$ is unique on the branch. This is the general-margin form of the monotonicity clause in Condition 1, and it is also what turns the boxes in which Section 4 locates the fixed point (located boxes) into per-slab $\alpha_\star$ intervals: a certified sign of G at a located box is a certified side of $\alpha_\star$. The branch is increasing in α: P is increasing, since $\tanh^2(\sqrt{\psi}\,|z|)$ increases with ψ for each z; R is linear in α and increasing in q (Lemma 2); so $q'_\star(\alpha) = P'(\psi_\star)\,(R/\alpha)\big/\big(1-(P\circ R_\alpha)'(q_\star)\big) > 0$, and $\psi_\star = R(q_\star, \alpha)$ increases with it. Hence the hull of the boxes located at the two ends of an α interval contains $(q_\star(\alpha), \psi_\star(\alpha))$ for every α in the interval.

Lemma 2 (derivative of R)**.** *For all $\alpha > 0$, $\kappa \in \mathbb{R}$ and $0 < q < 1$,*

$$\frac{\partial R}{\partial q} = \frac{\alpha}{(1-q)^2}\,\mathbb{E}\Big[E'(u)^2 + 2\,E(u)^2E'(u)\Big] \;>\; 0.$$

Proof. Differentiating (1) in q produces $R/(1-q) + \frac{\alpha}{1-q}\mathbb{E}[2EE'u_q]$. Splitting u_q as in Lemma 1 and applying Stein's lemma to $\mathbb{E}[z\,EE'(u)]$ (with $(EE')' = E'^2 + EE''$ and $E'' = E'(E-u) + EE' - E$) turns the cross term into

$$\mathbb{E}[2EE'u_q] = \frac{\mathbb{E}[E'^2 + 2E^2E' - E^2]}{1-q},$$

and the $-\alpha\mathbb{E}[E^2]/(1-q)^2$ piece cancels $R/(1-q)$ exactly. Positivity is immediate since $E' \in (0,1)$. In both proofs differentiation under the integral sign is dominated ($|z\tanh(\sqrt{\psi}z)| \le \sqrt{\psi}\,z^2$, and the q-integrands grow at most quadratically in $|z|$, locally uniformly in the parameters), and Stein's lemma applies because $E(u(z))$ and $(EE')(u(z))$ are absolutely continuous with bounded derivative in z. □

With $B(q) = (1-q)\mathbb{E}[E(u)^2]$ one has $R = \alpha B(q)/(1-q)^2$, and Nakajima's computation of B' [13, eq. (18)] gives at every margin the monotonicity of R that Ding and Sun prove at $\kappa = 0$ [9, Lemma 7.3]. The one-term form is used twice: the integrand is a product of quantities with classical bounds, so its interval enclosure is tight enough for the contraction product on each slab; and positivity makes $q \mapsto P(R(q))$ increasing, which is what the location step of Section 4 bisects on.

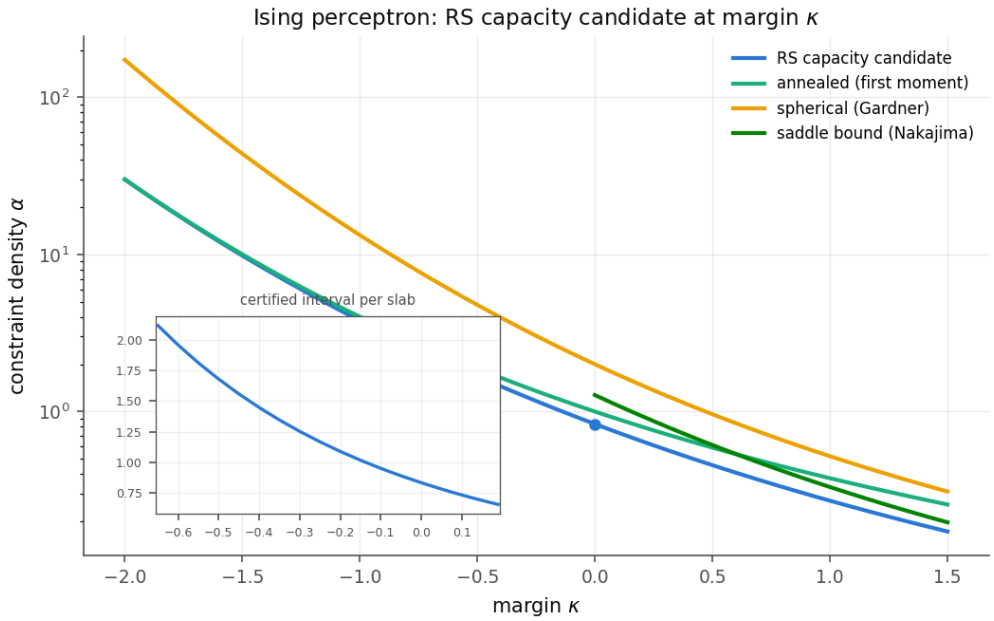


Figure 1: The replica-symmetric threshold $\alpha_\star(\kappa)$ (warm-started continuation from the certified value at $\kappa = 0$), the annealed bound $\log 2/(-\log \Psi(\kappa))$, the spherical capacity $\alpha_{\mathrm{sph}}(\kappa) = 1/\mathbb{E}[(\kappa - Z)_+^2]$ [2], and the bound $\alpha_c(\kappa) = 2/(\pi\, \mathbb{E}[(\kappa - Z)_+^2])$ of Nakajima's uniqueness theorem for $\kappa \geq 0$. The inset shows the per-slab $\alpha_\star$ intervals on the strip.

3 The capacity curve and the four conditions along it

A warm-started continuation in high-precision floating point (not a certificate; Figure 1) follows the fixed point along $\kappa \in [-2.0, 1.5]$, recording at each of 71 points the threshold, the fixed point, the contraction $(P \circ R_\alpha)'(q_\star)$, the left side of Condition 2 and the local-concavity minimum ℓ_0. Selected values:

κ	$\alpha_\star$	$q_\star$	$(P \circ R)'$	AMP	ℓ_0
-2.0	29.9921	0.11863	0.387	0.440	-0.147
-1.0	3.79463	0.36519	0.583	0.607	-0.099
-0.5	1.67884	0.47377	0.666	0.589	-0.132
0	0.83308	0.56395	0.744	0.544	-0.191
0.5	0.45566	0.63841	0.810	0.489	-0.271
1.0	0.27070	0.69988	0.863	0.433	-0.359
1.5	0.17245	0.75049	0.903	0.381	-0.442

Conditions 1–3 are satisfied in floating point at every point computed. The contraction is the only quantity trending toward failure, and only slowly; ℓ_0 approaches zero nearest $\kappa \approx -1.3$ (about -0.094) and then strengthens again. On the positive branch $\alpha_\star(\kappa)$ stays below the bound $\alpha_c(\kappa)$ at every grid point (worst ratio 0.874 at $\kappa = 1.5$). Toward $\kappa = -2$, the lower edge of the computed range, the threshold approaches the annealed bound from below, as it must where the constraints trivialize.

4 Certificates on a strip

For κ in slabs of width $5\cdot10^{-4}$ covering $[-0.65, 0.19]$, with per-slab parameter rectangles seeded by the continuation, we verify Conditions 1–3 in ball arithmetic (a rectangle is a product of intervals in (α, q), a box a product of intervals in (q_0, ψ_0)) (`python-flint` 0.9.0 on FLINT 3.6.0, 80-bit working precision, every input a ball covering the whole slab).

4.1 Numerical architecture

The computation rests on three rules.

First, adaptive complex quadrature cannot resolve enclosure width that comes from parameter balls: subdividing the integration variable does not shrink it. So every wide-parameter integral is a real-cell Riemann sum with exact per-cell Gaussian masses. Second, the ball evaluation of φ/Ψ fails on wide arguments in the steep region (the enclosure of Ψ crosses zero), while the ratio is monotone; all factors built from φ/Ψ are therefore enclosed by two thin endpoint evaluations, and the sign-critical sums use the mean-value cell rule (midpoint value plus a derivative correction; on a cell of width h its error is $O(h^2)$ against the plain hull's $O(h)$, with constants set by the derivative enclosures on that cell). Third, expectations that nearly cancel must be evaluated as one correlated integrand, never as separate sums whose parameter widths add. For Condition 3 this is the identity (with $\tau = E'$, $A = 1 - q_0$, and $\beta = \mu(\hat{z}) - A$ for $\mu(\hat{z}) = \mathbb{E}[(\hat{z} + \cosh^2(\sqrt{\psi_0}Z))^{-1}]$)

$$\ell(\hat{z}) = \hat{z} + \alpha_\star \mathbb{E}\left[\frac{\beta\,\tau^2}{A(A+\beta\tau)}\right].$$

Indeed $F'(\sqrt{q_0}Z) = -\tau/A$, so $\hat{f}_0 = \tau/(A(1-\tau))$, $\hat{f}_0/(1+\mu\hat{f}_0) = \tau/(A+\beta\tau)$ and $d_0 = -\alpha_\star\mathbb{E}[\tau]/A$, and $\tau/A - \tau/(A+\beta\tau) = \beta\tau^2/(A(A+\beta\tau))$. The integrand is monotone in τ for fixed (μ, A), regular on all of $\tau \in [0,1]$, and bounded by $|\beta|/(A\mu)$: the map $\tau \mapsto \tau^2/(A+\beta\tau)$ has derivative $\tau(2A+\beta\tau)/(A+\beta\tau)^2$, and $A+\beta\tau$ lies between A and $A+\beta = \mu$, both positive, so $2A + \beta\tau = A + (A+\beta\tau) > 0$; the integrand is therefore monotone in τ, and its absolute value is at most its value at $\tau = 1$, which is $|\beta|/(A\mu)$.

4.2 Uniqueness by contraction

On each of the 1500 slabs of $[-0.65, 0.10]$ the checks are: (i) the contraction product $\sup_\psi P' \cdot \sup_q |\partial R/\partial q|$, which bounds $\sup_q (P \circ R_\alpha)'$, is below 1 on the slab rectangle, via Lemma 2; (ii) existence: the endpoints of the q interval map strictly inward under $P \circ R_\alpha$ on each of eight α sub-intervals; (iii) the crossing: at the two thin α endpoints a certified Picard iteration locates the fixed point (the invariant is that the image of any set containing the fixed point contains it) and the sign of G resolves through a mean-value form that keeps the stationarity cancellations of Lemma 1 explicit, $G(\alpha_-) > 0 > G(\alpha_+)$; (iv) Condition 2; (v) Condition 3 at Huang's witness $\hat{z} = -0.6693$. Together with the strict decrease of $G_\star$, (i)–(iii) discharge Condition 1 in full on the slab: $\alpha_\star(\kappa)$ exists, is unique, and lies in the slab's α interval for every κ in the slab.

The contraction product (i) is below 1 on each of these 1500 slabs; on $(0.10, 0.19]$ it is not below 1 on every slab (it exceeds 1 near $\kappa = 0.12$), and uniqueness there is treated in Section 4.3. Over a union of slabs the enclosure of $\partial R/\partial q$ is about twice too wide for it. On a

single slab the enclosure stays below 1 with slack 0.049 at $\kappa = 0$, growing to 0.198 at $\kappa = -0.65$ and thinning to 0.0083 at $\kappa = 0.10$.

The 1500 slabs are contiguous, cover $[-0.65, 0.10]$, and each satisfies (i)–(iii). The q interval of a slab must cover the drift of the fixed point across the slab's (α, κ) rectangle, which is dominated by $\partial q_\star/\partial\alpha \approx 0.92$ times the width of the α interval; at fixed α the partial derivative $\partial q_\star/\partial\kappa$ is about 1.0 (at $\kappa = 0.05$), while along the capacity curve q_0 changes at about 0.18 per unit of κ.

4.3 Uniqueness on $(0.10, 0.19]$

The contraction product exceeds 1 near $\kappa = 0.12$, while the contraction at the fixed point stays below 0.78. At $\kappa = 0.13$ the product over the slab rectangle is 1.32; a certified sign bisection of the displacement $P(R(q)) - q$ (which has certified signs at the interval endpoints and, by the uniqueness of the fixed point given by Nakajima's theorem (see below), a single zero between them, so it is positive below the fixed point and negative above) locates the fixed point at both α endpoints to width $2 \cdot 10^{-8}$ with no contraction input, the contraction evaluated on the located intervals reads 0.79, and the G crossing resolves with slack $2 \cdot 10^{-3}$.

The rectangle clause itself is then discharged at $\kappa = 0.13$ exactly as Huang's Proposition 3.2 discharges it at $\kappa = 0$: on the rectangle $\alpha \in [0.705932217, 0.705933898]$, $q \in [0.5836943, 0.5857104]$ (the located fixed points $\pm 10^{-3}$), the certified contraction product is 0.8435, the map is endpoint-inward at both α ends with slack above $2.3 \cdot 10^{-4}$, the G signs at the located fixed points are $+1.6 \cdot 10^{-7}$ and $-1.6 \cdot 10^{-6}$, and $\mathbb{E} \log \Psi < 0$ over the rectangle (`rect_cond31_0p13.json`; quadrature depth 16000). The value 1.32 comes from the width of the slab rectangle; the contraction at the fixed point $(P \circ R_\alpha)'(q_\star)$ is nearly flat, rising only from 0.758 at $\kappa = 0.10$ to 0.770 at $\kappa = 0.19$, everywhere below 1 by more than 0.22. The rectangle clause is therefore decided by the width of the rectangle: over $(0.10, 0.19]$ (`rect_strip_nak.jsonl`, per sub-slab) the product is below 1 at $\kappa = 0.10$ with a padding of $2 \cdot 10^{-3}$ in q but exceeds it (1.012) by $\kappa = 0.15$ with the same padding. The width of the rectangle in q is set by the located q interval, whose width comes mostly from the slab's α width $(3 \cdot 10^{-3})$ through $\partial q_\star/\partial\alpha \approx 0.9$; narrowing it means enclosing $\alpha_\star$ at a single κ in an interval of width about 10^{-6}, as is done below at the five margins, after which the flat contraction leaves a thin rectangle that clears 1. At $\kappa = 0.15$ and 0.185 the contraction products on such rectangles are 0.836 and 0.830 (`rect_cond31_0p15.json`, `rect_cond31_0p185.json`). On each of the 180 slabs covering $[0.10, 0.19]$, over eight sub-slabs of width $6.25 \cdot 10^{-5}$, the located rectangle is endpoint-inward at both α ends and carries a certified contraction product below one, the worst bound being 0.958 (`rect_strip_nak_thin_*.jsonl`, collected with the input hashes bound in `rect_strip_thin_summary.json`). On a sub-slab the located rectangle is the slab's α interval times the q interval running from $5 \cdot 10^{-4}$ below the lower to $5 \cdot 10^{-4}$ above the upper of the fixed points located at the two ends of that interval. With the inward endpoints and Lemma 2's monotonicity this gives, for every $\kappa \in (0.10, 0.19]$, a rectangle on which the fixed point is unique by the contraction itself, so the rectangle clause of Condition 1 holds on every slab.

The other checks on these 180 slabs are: existence by the same inward test; location by certified sign bisection per sub-slab (the κ width floors the displacement's sign resolution, so each slab runs eight sub-slabs whose union covers it); the contraction used only on located intervals, which is the local form Huang's perturbation argument uses; and uniqueness, a second

time, from Nakajima's uniqueness theorem [13], whose premise $\alpha_+ < \alpha_c(\kappa) = 2/(\pi\,\mathbb{E}[(\kappa - Z)_+^2])$ is certified per slab through the closed form $\mathbb{E}[(\kappa - Z)_+^2] = (1+\kappa^2)\big(1-\Psi(\kappa)\big) + \kappa\varphi(\kappa)$ (the least certified value of $\alpha_c(\kappa) - \alpha_+$ is 0.292).

On the whole strip, 1680 contiguous slabs pass and none fails. At each of five margins a certified bisection on the sign of G at located boxes encloses $\alpha_\star$ in an interval of width about $2 \cdot 10^{-6}$; these deep $\alpha_\star$ intervals are the intervals of Theorem 4. Each contains its continuation value, and the slab containing $\kappa = 0$ contains $\alpha_\star(0) = 0.8330786\ldots$. At the default quadrature depth the enclosure of G limits the width to $1.4 \cdot 10^{-5}$; the five intervals use a larger depth.

5 The two-variable function

5.1 The maximizer and its Hessian

The local ingredient of Condition 4 is the negative definiteness of the Hessian $\mathcal{H}$ at $(1,0)$ of the two-variable function of Section 5.2 with the tilt held at its optimal value $s_0 = \sqrt{1-q_0}$; at $\kappa = 0$ this is [10, Claim 2.6], verified in his Appendix B.3. The second derivative in the tilt is positive: it is $\psi_0 - \alpha\mathbb{E}[E'\eta^2]$ in the notation of Section 5.2, with $0 < E' < 1$ (Lemma 3) and $\alpha\mathbb{E}[\eta^2] = \psi_0$. Minimizing over the tilt therefore subtracts a positive semidefinite matrix (a Schur complement), so the Hessian of the tilt-optimized function at $(1,0)$ is bounded above by $\mathcal{H}$ in the Loewner order and is negative definite whenever $\mathcal{H}$ is. His second-derivative expansion, *before* the zero-margin specialization, gives at every κ the same quadratic form

$$\langle \xi, \mathcal{H}\xi\rangle = -(I_1\xi_1^2 + 2I_2\xi_1\xi_2 + I_3\xi_2^2) + C_1 y_1^2 + C_2 y_1 y_2 + C_3 y_2^2,$$

where $y_1 = I_1\xi_1 + I_2\xi_2$ and $y_2 = I_2\xi_1 + I_3\xi_2$, with prior-side integrals I_j unchanged in form ($I_1 = \psi_0(1-q_0) - 2\psi_0^2(1 - 4q_0 + 3p_4)$, $I_2 = \psi_0(1 - 4q_0 + 3p_4)$, $I_3 = q_0 - p_4$, $p_4 = \mathbb{E}\tanh^4(\sqrt{\psi_0}Z)$) and constraint-side constants C_j that at $\kappa \neq 0$ must be taken from the pre-specialization display. Put $\hat{H} = \sqrt{q_0}\,Z$, $u = (\kappa - \hat{H})/\sqrt{1-q_0}$, $\eta = E(u)/\sqrt{1-q_0}$ and $F' = -E'(u)/(1-q_0)$. His zero-margin closed forms rest on two identities of the unshifted law, of which $\alpha\,\mathbb{E}[\eta^2] = \psi_0$ survives at every margin (it is the same identity behind the unbounded-tilt directions of Section 5.2) while $\alpha\,\mathbb{E}[\eta\hat{H}] = -q_0(1-q_0)\psi_0$ does not. We evaluate the general-margin C_j directly. With $Q = -\hat{H}/q_0 + \big(\kappa - \hat{H} - (1-q_0)\eta\big)/(1-q_0)$, every expectation over the single Gaussian $\hat{H}$,

$$C_1 = \frac{\alpha}{\psi_0^2}\,\mathbb{E}[F'\eta^2], \qquad C_2 = -\frac{2\alpha}{\psi_0}\,\mathbb{E}[F'\eta Q] + \frac{2}{1-q_0},$$

$$C_3 = \alpha\,\mathbb{E}[F'Q^2] + \frac{2\alpha}{q_0(1-q_0)}\,\mathbb{E}[\eta\hat{H}] - \alpha\Big(\frac{3}{(1-q_0)^2} + \frac{1}{q_0(1-q_0)}\Big)\mathbb{E}\big[\eta\,(\kappa - \hat{H} - (1-q_0)\eta)\big].$$

The certified evaluation encloses each expectation by the mean-value cell rule with explicit quadratic tail majorants (η grows at most linearly on the left tail, F' is bounded by $1/(1-q_0)$ in magnitude, and every integrand is degree at most two in $|z|$), and the near-cancelling prior moments are evaluated as single correlated integrands. The certified enclosures at the six

margins are one-sided where sign is the claim:

$$\begin{array}{lll}
\kappa=-0.45: & \mathcal{H}_{11}\le -0.0647, & \det\mathcal{H}\ge 2.9\cdot 10^{-4},\\
\kappa=-0.05: & \mathcal{H}_{11}\le -0.0471, & \det\mathcal{H}\ge 1.6\cdot 10^{-4},\\
\kappa=0: & \mathcal{H}_{11}\le -0.0451, & \det\mathcal{H}\ge 1.8\cdot 10^{-4},\\
\kappa=0.05: & \mathcal{H}_{11}\le -0.0424, & \det\mathcal{H}\ge 1.2\cdot 10^{-4},\\
\kappa=0.0995: & \mathcal{H}_{11}\le -0.0400, & \det\mathcal{H}\ge 1.0\cdot 10^{-4},\\
\kappa=0.13: & \mathcal{H}_{11}\le -0.0385, & \det\mathcal{H}\ge 8.8\cdot 10^{-5}.
\end{array}$$

The bound on $|\mathcal{H}_{11}|$ decreases as κ increases.

Certification requires parameter boxes far tighter than the slabs provide (the C_j move with q at rate about 10, while $\det\mathcal{H}\sim 10^{-4}$), which is what the deep $\alpha_\star$ intervals above are for. Iterating $q\mapsto P(R(q,\alpha))$ over the whole deep $\alpha_\star$ interval gives boxes that contain the fixed point for every α in it ($3.6\cdot 10^{-6}$ in q_0, $5.2\cdot 10^{-5}$ in ψ_0 at $\kappa=0.05$). On these boxes the certificate resolves: $\mathcal{H}_{11}<0$ and $\det\mathcal{H}>0$ in ball arithmetic, with the near-cancellations $1-4q_0+3p_4$ and q_0-p_4 evaluated as single correlated integrands and the five constraint-side integrals by mean-value Riemann sums with elementary derivatives of φ/Ψ. The same chain certifies at $\kappa=0$ on the parameter rectangle of [9, Section 7], where the C_j enclosures lie inside Huang's certified intervals, and at -0.05, 0.0995, -0.45 (where $C_1=-0.855$, against -0.718 at zero margin) and 0.13.

Along the continuation $\mathcal{H}$ stays negative definite at least up to $\kappa=1.15$ and loses definiteness inside $(1.1812, 1.1844)$, while the Hessian of the tilt-optimized function remains negative out to at least $\kappa=1.5$, as the Schur relation allows, so past $\kappa\approx 1.18$ a local argument must re-optimize the tilt, as the ray certificates below already do.

5.2 The function at general margin

Huang's two-variable function at margin κ, in the form his proof uses, is

$$\mathcal{S}(\Lambda,s)=\frac{s^2\psi_0}{2}+\mathrm{ent}(\Lambda)+\alpha\,\mathbb{E}\log\Psi\left(\frac{\kappa-(a_2/q_0)\hat{H}-(a_1/\psi_0)\eta}{D}+s\eta\right),$$

where $\dot{H}\sim N(0,\psi_0)$ and $\hat{H}\sim N(0,q_0)$ are independent, $M=\tanh\dot{H}$ (Huang's notation), the profile Λ is a function of $\dot{H}$ with $|\Lambda|\le 1$, $\mathrm{ent}(\Lambda)=\mathbb{E}\,h\big(\frac{1+\Lambda}{2}\big)$ with $h(p)=-p\log p-(1-p)\log(1-p)$, $\eta=E(u)/\sqrt{1-q_0}$ is the variable of Section 5.1 (the margin enters through η and through the additive κ in the $\log\Psi$ argument), $a_1=\mathbb{E}[\dot{H}\Lambda]$, $a_2=\mathbb{E}[M\Lambda]$, $D=D(a)=\sqrt{1-a_2^2/q_0}$, and $\mathcal{S}_\star(\lambda_1,\lambda_2)=\inf_{s\ge 0}\mathcal{S}(\tanh(\lambda_1\dot{H}+\lambda_2 M),s)$. Condition 4 asks $\mathcal{S}_\star\le 0$ everywhere.

The moment reduction [14, Lemma 5.1] holds at every κ with the same proof, because the margin enters only the constraint term. The profile enters only through the moment pair $a(\Lambda)=(\mathbb{E}[\dot{H}\Lambda],\mathbb{E}[M\Lambda])$, which ranges over a compact convex body K (the moment body of $(\dot{H},M)$), and on K the entropy term is bounded through $H(a)=\max\{\mathrm{ent}(\Lambda):\mathbb{E}[\dot{H}\Lambda]=a_1,\ \mathbb{E}[M\Lambda]=a_2\}$ by convex duality, $H(a)\le\Phi(b)-b\cdot a$ for every dual point b, with $\Phi(b)=\mathbb{E}\log 2\cosh(b_1\dot{H}+b_2M)$ free of κ. With

$$\mathcal{F}(a,s)=\frac{s^2\psi_0}{2}+H(a)+\alpha\,\mathbb{E}\log\Psi\left(\frac{\kappa-(a_2/q_0)\hat{H}-(a_1/\psi_0)\eta}{D(a)}+s\eta\right),\qquad \bar{\mathcal{S}}(a)=\inf_{s\ge 0}\mathcal{F}(a,s),$$

the lemma gives

$$\mathcal{S}_\star(\lambda) \le \bar{\mathcal{S}}\big(a(\tanh(\lambda_1\dot{H} + \lambda_2 M))\big), \qquad \lambda \in \mathbb{R}^2.$$

The certificates bound $\mathcal{F}$ with $H(a)$ replaced by $\Phi(b) - b \cdot a$ at the dual point b of each cell. Two structural facts organize the verification. The maximizing profile $\tanh \dot{H}$, that is $\lambda = (1, 0)$, has moment point $a^\star = (\psi_0(1 - q_0),\, q_0)$ for every κ: this is the base-point identity $\nabla\Phi(1, 0) = (\mathbb{E}[\dot{H}M], \mathbb{E}[M^2]) = (\psi_0(1 - q_0), q_0)$ (Gaussian integration by parts and the fixed-point equations), and [10, Lemma 7.15] gives $\mathcal{S}_\star = 0$ there with optimal tilt $s_0 = \sqrt{1 - q_0}$, both in closed form. And on a region close to the half-plane $\lambda_1 < 0$ the s-infimum is $-\infty$: $\alpha\,\mathbb{E}[\eta^2] = \psi_0$ exactly at the fixed point, so the quadratic tilt coefficient cancels, and wherever the surviving linear coefficient of the tilt is nonpositive the function runs away (in floating point, the boundary of that region at $\kappa = 0.05$ crosses $\lambda_1 = 0.04$ on the $\lambda_2 = 0$ axis and bends left as $|\lambda_2|$ grows). Condition 4 takes the infimum over all $s \ge 0$, so a negative value at one finite tilt is a witness, and the certificates of Section 6 exhibit one cell by cell.

In floating point the function is nearly the same at every κ of the curve: a single peak at $(1, 0)$, off-center values below $-3 \cdot 10^{-3}$, negative far rays, Hessian eigenvalues near -0.22 and -0.0045, distance near 0.017 from the boundary of K, with the weak eigenvalue degrading toward deep negative margin (-0.0013 at $\kappa = -1.5$).

6 Certifying the two-variable condition

The zero-margin certificate has four parts: a sweep of the moment body outside an exclusion region (Region II), the exclusion region being a product of two intervals about $a^\star$ in the moment plane that contains the star; ray certificates on the star, one for each radial band and angular cell (Region I); a second sweep of the exclusion region minus the star (stage 2); and an interior-ball certificate placing the star strictly inside the moment body. At $\kappa \neq 0$ all four meet the same difficulty. At zero margin the parameters (q_0, ψ_0) are certified to a box of width $8 \cdot 10^{-10}$ in q_0 and $1.2 \cdot 10^{-8}$ in ψ_0, so the moment point $a^\star$ can be stored as decimals and every enclosure treats them as exact; at $\kappa = 0.05$ the hull of the boxes located at the two ends of the deep $\alpha_\star$ interval has width $1.5 \cdot 10^{-6}$ in q_0 and $9.2 \cdot 10^{-5}$ in ψ_0 (at each end q_0 is located to $1.5 \cdot 10^{-9}$ and ψ_0 is enclosed as $R(q_0, \alpha)$ by a Riemann sum of 4000 cells, to width $6.9 \cdot 10^{-5}$). The certificates of this section use this hull; the box of Section 5.1 is narrower in ψ_0 and wider in q_0, and both contain the fixed point for every α of the deep $\alpha_\star$ interval. The width of the hull enters every plain evaluation of Φ at about $2 \cdot 10^{-5}$, much wider than the differences of order 10^{-7} whose signs place the dual points. Four changes make the four certificates apply at $\kappa \neq 0$: $a^\star$ computed from the box, one tilt slope per angular sector on the rays, differences of Φ written against $b_0 = (1, 0)$, and kernels that stay finite where the argument of the inverse Mills ratio is large.

The moment point from the box. Every certificate that references $a^\star$ or the base tilt s_0 uses them as the functions $(\,\psi_0(1 - q_0),\, q_0\,)$ and $\sqrt{1 - q_0}$ of the box, never as stored decimals; the enclosure of $a^\star$ is the image of the box under the first of these maps. The true $a^\star$, at the true parameters, is therefore covered exactly, and the identities at $a^\star$ ($\mathcal{S} = 0$, $\nabla\mathcal{S} = 0$ and tilt optimality, at the true $a^\star$) hold on the certified rays with no enlargement of the enclosure. Certificates evaluated over the enclosure of $a^\star$ cover in particular the rays from the true $a^\star$.

The ray argument. The ray part of [14, Lemma 6.1] carries over; what changes at $\kappa \neq 0$ is the choice of slope. For a unit direction v and a slope $c \in \mathbb{R}$ put $\chi_{v,c}(t) = \mathcal{F}(a^\star + tv,\, s_0 + ct)$,

with $\mathcal{F}$ as in Section 5, so that $\bar{\mathcal{S}}(a^\star + tv) \le \chi_{v,c}(t)$ whenever $s_0 + ct \ge 0$. At the true parameters $\chi_{v,c}(0) = \chi'_{v,c}(0) = 0$ for every c, by the identities at $a^\star$. If $\chi''_{v,c} \le 0$ on $[0, T(v)]$ then $\chi_{v,c} \le 0$ there, hence $\bar{\mathcal{S}} \le 0$ on the segment. The chain needs one slope per ray: the second-derivative bound on a radial band $[t_0, t_1]$ with $t_0 > 0$ says nothing about χ itself unless χ and χ' are controlled at t_0, and those are controlled only through the same function on $[0, t_0]$. The certificates therefore fix the slope by direction alone: the circle is cut into 768 equal sectors, each sector carries one slope (the optimal tilt slope at its midpoint, rounded to six decimals), every angular cell of every radial band lies inside one sector and uses that sector's slope, and a direction on a sector edge is covered by the cells of either neighbor, each with its own fixed slope. Each cell lies in one sector, the cells of each band tile its angle range, and the main and supplementary certificates use the same slope table.

Differences against b_0. The dual localization of [14, Lemma 6.1], which keeps the dual maximizer $\lambda(x)$ inside a certified region of the dual plane (its dual enclosure) so that the entropy Hessian can be bounded there, needs signs of differences $\Phi(\lambda) - \Phi(\lambda') - (\lambda - \lambda') \cdot x$ for pairs of dual points λ, λ' and moment points x near $a^\star$. Evaluated as differences of plain Φ enclosures these carry the width of the box twice. Written against $b_0 = (1, 0)$, the integrand collapses exactly: with $\Delta = (\lambda_1 - 1)\dot{H} + \lambda_2 M$,

$$\log \frac{\cosh(\dot{H} + \Delta)}{\cosh \dot{H}} - (\lambda - b_0) \cdot \nabla_b \log 2\cosh(b \cdot (\dot{H}, M))\big|_{b_0} = \log\big(\cosh \Delta + M \sinh \Delta\big) - M\Delta,$$

because the gradient of $b \mapsto \log 2\cosh(b \cdot (\dot{H}, M))$ at b_0 is $M\,(\dot{H}, M)$, whose inner product with $\lambda - b_0$ is $M\Delta$. Every factor is a small ball with thin coefficients, so the parameter width enters only at second order in $|\lambda - b_0|$; within distance 0.01 of b_0, where plain differences of enclosures fail, the enclosures are 50 to 160 times tighter, and at b_0 the enclosure is exactly $\{0\}$. Differences between arbitrary points are then differences of two such enclosures, and the gradient term the localization needs is the same trick applied to $\nabla\Phi$: $\nabla\Phi(\lambda) - \nabla\Phi(b_0)$ has the exact per-node form $(\dot{H}, M)\,(1 - M^2)\tanh\Delta/(1 + M\tanh\Delta)$.

The factor $\cosh\Delta + M\sinh\Delta$ itself has two exact evaluations with disjoint stability regimes: the cosh/sinh form is exact at $\Delta = 0$ (which the differences of order 10^{-7} in the bands nearest $a^\star$ require) but subtracts two $e^{|\Delta|}$-sized balls when $M \approx \pm 1$ and $|\Delta|$ is large, where the enclosure of the factor contains 0 and its logarithm is not enclosed; the split $e^{\Delta}(1+M)/2 + e^{-\Delta}(1-M)/2$ has both terms nonnegative on the real axis but carries first-order M-width near $\Delta = 0$. The first form is used at nodes with $|\Delta| \le 1$, the second at the others; both forms are identities, so the choice affects tightness only.

Kernels at large arguments. The ray certificates use second derivatives of the constraint term, whose kernels involve $E'(V) = E(V)(E(V) - V)$ and $E''(V)$, with E the inverse Mills ratio of Section 2, evaluated at arguments V that reach about 20 on far quadrature cells; there $E(V) - V$ is a difference of two large balls and the enclosures of the kernels are useless. The bounds of the following lemma, applied as intersections with the computed balls, remove the failure; the intersection of an enclosure with a proven bound is again an enclosure.

Lemma 3 (bounds on the inverse Mills ratio)**.** *Let E be the inverse Mills ratio and $\sigma = E - V$. For every $V \in \mathbb{R}$,*

$$\sigma > 0 \quad \Big(\textit{and } \sigma < \frac{1}{V} \textit{ for } V > 0\Big), \qquad E' = E\sigma \in (0, 1), \qquad 0 < E'' < \sigma.$$

Proof. For $V \le 0$, $\sigma > 0$ because $E > 0$. For $V > 0$ the bounds $V < E(V) < V + 1/V$ are Gordon's inequalities [7], which give $0 < \sigma < 1/V$. The bounds $0 < E' < 1$ are due to Sampford [8]; in the present notation $E' = E^2 - VE = E\sigma$, and $1 - E' = \mathrm{Var}(Z \mid Z > V)$ by the conditional moments $\mathbb{E}[Z \mid Z > V] = E$ and $\mathbb{E}[Z^2 \mid Z > V] = 1 + VE$, which are used again below. The upper bound on E'' is the identity $E'' - \sigma = (E' - 1)(E + \sigma)$ with $E' < 1$ and $E + \sigma > 0$.

Positivity of E'' is the convexity of the inverse Mills ratio. Differentiating E' gives $E'' = E\,[\,\sigma(E+\sigma) - 1\,]$, and for W distributed as $Z - V$ conditioned on $\{Z > V\}$ the moment formulas above read $\mathbb{E}W = \sigma$ and $\mathbb{E}[W^2] = 1 - VE + V^2$, whence $\sigma(E+\sigma) - 1 = 2(\mathbb{E}W)^2 - \mathbb{E}[W^2]$: the claim is that this residual law has coefficient of variation below one. Its survival function is $\mathbb{P}(W > w) = \Psi(V + w)/\Psi(V) = e^{-\Gamma(w)}$ with $\Gamma(w) = \int_0^w E(V + x)\,dx$ convex, since $E' > 0$. Set $\theta = 1/\sigma$, so the rate-θ exponential has the same mean, and $J(w) = \Gamma(w) - \theta w$. Then J is convex with $J(0) = 0$, $J'(0) = E - 1/\sigma < 0$ (this is $E\sigma = E' < 1$ again), and $J(w) \to \infty$, so $J < 0$ exactly on some interval $(0, w_0)$ and $J > 0$ past it. Hence $\mathbb{P}(W > w) - e^{-\theta w} = e^{-\theta w}(e^{-J(w)} - 1)$ is positive before w_0 and negative after, while $\int_0^\infty (\mathbb{P}(W > w) - e^{-\theta w})\,dw = \sigma - \sigma = 0$. Therefore

$$\tfrac{1}{2}\,\mathbb{E}[W^2] - \sigma^2 = \int_0^\infty w\,\big(\mathbb{P}(W > w) - e^{-\theta w}\big)\,dw = \int_0^\infty (w - w_0)\big(\mathbb{P}(W > w) - e^{-\theta w}\big)\,dw < 0,$$

the last integrand being nonpositive and not almost everywhere zero. So $\mathbb{E}[W^2] < 2(\mathbb{E}W)^2$, that is $E'' > 0$, at every real V. □

With these four changes the four certificates hold at each of the five margins. We give the counts at $\kappa = 0.05$; the other margins are in Section 7. At $\kappa = 0.05$, on that hull and the deep $\alpha_\star$ interval of Section 4:

(i) *Region II*: the 1296 cells of a 48×27 grid on $[-1.351, 1.351] \times [-0.76, 0.76]$, which contains K; cells inside the exclusion region or outside K need no bound, and the others are bisected until the duality bound certifies each piece, 855 certified pieces (the leaves) in all, zero failures.

(ii) *Region I*: the ray certificates over the star, 1404 bands from $a^\star$, zero failures; the certified band values lie between $-1.6 \cdot 10^2$ and $-7.5 \cdot 10^{-5}$. The main star has radius 0.012 within 0.16 radians of the weak direction, the line through $a^\star$ along a unit eigenvector of the Hessian of $\bar{\mathcal{S}}$ at $a^\star$ for its eigenvalue nearest 0 (a floating-point estimate; the certificates hold for any choice of these angles), 0.008 out to 0.45 radians and 0.005 beyond. Twelve supplementary arcs, angular ranges 0.14 to 0.19 radians off the weak direction, certify radius 0.0105 there (certified values $-3.5 \cdot 10^{-3}$ to -1.9), as the stage-2 leaves near those arcs require.

(iii) *Stage 2*: the exclusion region minus the star, 1363 leaves, zero failures. Star containment uses the certified radius of Region I: a certified band covers every direction of its angular range out to the star boundary, so the certified radius is the pointwise maximum of the main radius and the supplementary arcs, a piecewise-constant function of the angle.

(iv) *Star interior*: the certificate of [14, Lemma 5.2], run over the enclosure of $a^\star$, places the star strictly inside the moment body: constructive inradius 0.01481 against required 0.01209.

Together: $\mathcal{S}_\star \le 0$ on the whole plane at $\kappa = 0.05$. All four of Huang's conditions hold there, and his theorem gives the unconditional bound.

Theorem 4. *Let $\kappa \in \{-0.45,\ -0.05,\ 0.05,\ 0.0995,\ 0.13\}$. Then $\alpha_\star(\kappa)$ lies in the corresponding interval*

$$\alpha_\star(-0.45) \in [1.557652103,\ 1.557654133], \quad \alpha_\star(-0.05) \in [0.889408031,\ 0.889409783],$$
$$\alpha_\star(0.05) \in [0.781073068,\ 0.781074776], \quad \alpha_\star(0.0995) \in [0.733478513,\ 0.733480205],$$
$$\alpha_\star(0.13) \in [0.705932217,\ 0.705933898],$$

and for every α above that interval

$$\lim_{N\to\infty} \mathbb{P}\Big(\exists\, w \in \{-1,+1\}^N :\ \frac{\langle g_a, w\rangle}{\sqrt{N}} \ge \kappa \text{ for all } a \le \lceil \alpha N \rceil\Big) = 0.$$

The other three conditions hold on the whole strip. The 1680 slabs, each with its κ, α and q intervals, are listed in the verification repository, those with $\kappa \le 0.10$ in the file `certified_intervals.csv` and the others in the file `certified_intervals_nak.csv`.

Theorem 5. *(a) For every $\kappa \in [-0.65, 0.10]$, Conditions 1–3 hold, with the contraction of Condition 1 on the slab rectangle.*

(b) For every $\kappa \in (0.10, 0.19]$, Conditions 1–3 hold, with the contraction of Condition 1 on the located rectangles of Section 4.3; uniqueness of the fixed point also follows from Nakajima's uniqueness theorem [13], whose premise is verified on every slab.

(c) In both cases $\alpha_\star(\kappa)$ exists, is unique on the fixed-point branch, and lies in the α interval of the slab containing κ. If Condition 4 also holds at κ, then for every α above the upper end of that interval the probability that some $w \in \{-1,+1\}^N$ satisfies all $\lceil \alpha N \rceil$ constraints at margin κ tends to 0 as $N \to \infty$.

Condition 4 holds at the five margins of Theorem 4 and, by [14], at $\kappa = 0$. At every other κ of the strip, Theorem 5(c) reduces the upper bound to Condition 4 at that κ.

7 Further margins

Huang's four conditions are statements at one margin, and the certificates of Sections 5.2–6 run unchanged at any κ of the strip, with the boxes of (q_0, ψ_0) located at both ends of the α interval of that margin. Besides $\kappa = 0.05$, Condition 4 holds at $\kappa = -0.45$, -0.05, 0.0995 and 0.13. At the four margins with $\kappa \le 0.10$ the uniqueness of the fixed point comes from the contraction certificates of Section 4 alone; at $\kappa = 0.13$ Nakajima's uniqueness theorem gives it as well. Table 1 lists the certified pieces at the five margins.

For each band, the ray-certificate file of every margin carries a Loewner majorant $\bar{B}$, an interval matrix with $\nabla^2\Phi(\lambda) \preceq \bar{B}$ in the Loewner order (the difference is positive semidefinite) for every λ in the band's dual enclosure, so that the Hessian of the entropy term is at most $-\bar{B}^{-1}$ there. Every band's $\bar{B}$ is positive definite, a fact checked in exact rational arithmetic (Section 9).

κ	$\alpha_\star(\kappa)$ interval	Region II	Region I	stage 2	inradius / required
0.05	[0.781073068, 0.781074776]	855	1404 (+12)	1363	0.01481 / 0.01209
-0.45	[1.557652103, 1.557654133]	656	1404 (+12)	1196	0.01480 / 0.01207
-0.05	[0.889408031, 0.889409783]	867	1404 (+12)	1282	0.01527 / 0.01209
0.0995	[0.733478513, 0.733480205]	904	1404 (+12)	1390	0.01459 / 0.01209
0.13	[0.705932217, 0.705933898]	874	1404 (+12)	1422	0.01446 / 0.01210

Table 1: Certified leaf and band counts per piece, with zero failures in every certificate file. In the Region I column, (+12) marks the twelve supplementary arcs that follow the bands; the stage-2 lattice of every margin uses them. The final column gives the constructive moment-body inradius against the required star radius, both exact-arithmetic bounds.

7.1 From points to intervals

For Conditions 1–3 the strip certificates already give statements on intervals of κ: each slab is certified with every input enclosed over the whole slab. Condition 4 is different. Over a slab every certificate must hold with (α, q_0, ψ_0) replaced by their hulls, and the location step of Section 4 gives hulls no thinner than about $3.5 \cdot 10^{-4}$ in q_0; the induced enclosure of $a^\star$ has radius at least a few times 10^{-3} however narrow the slab, and at that radius the Region II cell enclosures are about ± 0.2, while the thinnest Region II cells have slack $5 \cdot 10^{-4}$ and the thinnest Region I bands between $1.1 \cdot 10^{-5}$ and $7.5 \cdot 10^{-5}$. An interval theorem for Condition 4 therefore needs a certified κ-derivative of each certificate, with the fixed-point branch differentiated implicitly, and quadratic control with explicit remainder bounds on the annulus between the star and the far cells, where the certified Hessian alone does not reach.

8 Toward the matching lower bound

Write $m_N(\kappa)$ for the largest m such that some $w \in \{-1, +1\}^N$ satisfies $\langle g_a, w \rangle / \sqrt{N} \geq \kappa$ for all $a \leq m$. Krauth and Mézard conjectured the value of the limiting ratio $m_N(\kappa)/N$ for every margin, not only at $\kappa = 0$ [1]; the constant 0.833 is the zero-margin point of the conjectured curve $\alpha_\star(\kappa)$. At $\kappa = 0$ the conjecture is resolved: Ding and Sun [9] proved $\alpha_\star$ is a lower bound with positive probability, the sharp-threshold sequence of Xu [11] and Nakajima and Sun [20] upgrades positive probability to convergence in probability, Huang [10] proved the matching upper bound, and the numerical hypotheses of both proofs are certified [14]. Away from $\kappa = 0$ the upper half is Theorem 4. For the lower half, the replica-symmetric free energy is proved at small constraint density by Talagrand [6] and, for a wider class of activations, by Bolthausen, Nakajima, Sun, and Xu [15]; no lower bound matching $\alpha_\star(\kappa)$ is known at $\kappa \neq 0$. There are three partial results: a lemma showing that plain second moments fail at every margin, an embedded bound that gives capacity lower bounds for $\kappa < 0$, and a floating-point evaluation of the κ-dependent inputs of the Ding–Sun argument at the five margins.

8.1 Plain second moments fail at every margin

Write $\mathcal{Z} = \mathcal{Z}_{N,\kappa}$ for the number of $w \in \{-1, +1\}^N$ satisfying all $m = \lceil \alpha N \rceil$ constraints, and $\varpi_\rho(\kappa) = \mathbb{P}(X \geq \kappa,\, Y \geq \kappa)$ for (X, Y) bivariate standard Gaussian with correlation ρ.

Lemma 6. *For every $\kappa \in \mathbb{R}$ and $\alpha > 0$,*

$$\liminf_{N\to\infty} \frac{1}{N} \log \frac{\mathbb{E}[\mathcal{Z}^2]}{(\mathbb{E}\mathcal{Z})^2} \;\geq\; \delta(\alpha,\kappa) \;>\; 0.$$

Consequently the guarantee of the Paley–Zygmund bound, $\mathbb{P}(\mathcal{Z} > 0) \geq (\mathbb{E}\mathcal{Z})^2/\mathbb{E}[\mathcal{Z}^2]$, is at most $e^{-\delta N + o(N)}$, and no bound depending on $\mathbb{E}\mathcal{Z}$ and $\mathbb{E}[\mathcal{Z}^2]$ alone can certify more, since a distribution placing mass $(\mathbb{E}\mathcal{Z})^2/\mathbb{E}[\mathcal{Z}^2]$ at $\mathbb{E}[\mathcal{Z}^2]/\mathbb{E}\mathcal{Z}$ and the rest at zero matches both moments. For $\kappa \geq 0$ the same conclusion holds for every weighted count $\mathcal{Z}_f = \sum_w \prod_a f(\langle g_a, w\rangle/\sqrt{N})$ with $f \geq 0$ supported on $[\kappa,\infty)$ and $0 < \int f\varphi\, dx < \infty$.

Proof. $\mathbb{E}\mathcal{Z} = 2^N \Psi(\kappa)^m$ by independence over constraints. For a pair w, w' at overlap ρ the constraint fields are bivariate Gaussian with correlation ρ, so counting ordered pairs by Hamming distance k,

$$\mathbb{E}[\mathcal{Z}^2] = 2^N \sum_{k=0}^{N} \binom{N}{k} \varpi_{1-2k/N}(\kappa)^m.$$

Fix $\rho_0 \in (0,1)$, let $k^* = \lceil N(1-\rho_0)/2 \rceil$ and $\rho^* = 1 - 2k^*/N$. Keeping the single term k^* and using $\binom{N}{k} \geq e^{Nh(k/N)}/(N+1)$ with h the natural-log binary entropy ($h(p) = h(1-p)$, so the exponent may be written with $(1+\rho_0)/2$),

$$\frac{1}{N}\log\frac{\mathbb{E}[\mathcal{Z}^2]}{(\mathbb{E}\mathcal{Z})^2} \geq \underbrace{h\Big(\tfrac{1+\rho_0}{2}\Big) - \log 2 + \alpha\big[\log \varpi_{\rho_0}(\kappa) - 2\log\Psi(\kappa)\big]}_{=:\,\zeta_{\alpha,\kappa}(\rho_0)} + O(N^{-1}\log N),$$

the error, of order $N^{-1}\log N$, collecting the binomial prefactor, the $|\rho^* - \rho_0| \leq 2/N$ continuity of $\rho \mapsto \log\varpi_\rho$ (differentiable, below), and $|m - \alpha N| \leq 1$. Now $\varpi_0 = \Psi(\kappa)^2$ and $h(1/2) = \log 2$ give $\zeta_{\alpha,\kappa}(0) = 0$. Reflecting the orthant to a joint CDF, $\varpi_\rho(\kappa) = N_2(-\kappa,-\kappa;\rho)$ with N_2 the bivariate normal distribution function, and Plackett's identity $\partial N_2/\partial\rho = \varphi_2$ with the symmetry $\varphi_2(-\kappa,-\kappa;\rho) = \varphi_2(\kappa,\kappa;\rho)$ give $\partial\varpi_\rho/\partial\rho = \varphi_2(\kappa,\kappa;\rho)$ on $(-1,1)$; at $\rho = 0$ this is $\varphi(\kappa)^2$. Since $\frac{d}{d\rho}h(\frac{1+\rho}{2}) = \frac{1}{2}\log\frac{1-\rho}{1+\rho}$ vanishes at 0,

$$\zeta'_{\alpha,\kappa}(0) = \alpha\,\frac{\varphi(\kappa)^2}{\Psi(\kappa)^2} \;>\; 0,$$

so $\zeta_{\alpha,\kappa}(\rho_0) \geq \rho_0\,\zeta'_{\alpha,\kappa}(0)/2 > 0$ for all small $\rho_0 > 0$; fix such a ρ_0 and set $\delta = \zeta_{\alpha,\kappa}(\rho_0)$. For the weighted counts, the diagonal term of $\mathbb{E}[\mathcal{Z}_f^2]$ is $2^N\mathbb{E}[f(X)^2]^m$, so either $\mathbb{E}[\mathcal{Z}_f^2] = \infty$ and the claim is trivial, or $f \in L^2(\varphi\,dx)$ and Mehler's expansion gives $\mathbb{E}[f(X)f(Y)] = \sum_{j\geq 0}\rho^j\langle f, \mathrm{He}_j\rangle^2/j!$, whose ρ-derivative at 0 is $(\int xf\varphi\,dx)^2$; for $f \geq 0$ supported on $[\kappa,\infty)$ with $\kappa \geq 0$ the integrand $xf(x)\varphi(x)$ is nonnegative, and it vanishes almost everywhere only if f vanishes almost everywhere off the origin, which $0 < \int f\varphi\,dx$ excludes; the argument then runs unchanged. □

The mechanism is the asymmetry: pairs of solutions at small positive overlap are exponentially favored over independent pairs at every margin, which is what the AMP-conditioned second moment of [9] is built to circumvent at $\kappa = 0$, and what any lower-bound proof must circumvent at every other margin. At $\kappa = 0$ the failure is classical (see the introduction of [9]); Lemma 6 extends it to every κ and, for $\kappa \geq 0$, to every weighted count. For $\kappa < 0$ the argument gives nothing for some weighted counts: a weight symmetric about the origin, such as the indicator $f = \mathbf{1}_{[-|\kappa|,|\kappa|]}$ of an interval, has $\int xf\varphi\,dx = 0$, so the first-order term vanishes.

8.2 A capacity lower bound at negative margins

Proposition 7. *Let $\kappa < 0$ and let $\alpha_c^{\mathrm{sym}}(r) = \log 2/(-\log \mathbb{P}(|X| \le r))$ denote the symmetric binary perceptron threshold at width r. For every $\alpha < \alpha_c^{\mathrm{sym}}(|\kappa|)$, with probability $1 - o(1)$ the margin-κ perceptron admits a solution, that is, $m_N(\kappa)/N \ge \alpha$.*

Proof. If $|\langle g_a, w\rangle|/\sqrt{N} \le -\kappa$ for all a then in particular $\langle g_a, w\rangle/\sqrt{N} \ge \kappa$, so the symmetric solution set at width $|\kappa|$ embeds in the margin-κ solution set. The value $\alpha_c^{\mathrm{sym}}(r)$ is the first-moment threshold of Aubin, Perkins and Zdeborová [16]. Altschuler's Theorem 1.4 [19] states that for every width $r > 0$ and every $\varepsilon > 0$ there is $c > 0$ such that, when the rows $g_a/\sqrt{N}$ are independent $N(0, N^{-1}I_N)$ vectors and their number is below $\alpha_c^{\mathrm{sym}}(r)N - c\log N$, a binary w with $|\langle g_a, w\rangle|/\sqrt{N} \le r$ for every a exists with probability at least $1 - \varepsilon$ for N large. Its proof uses the second-moment condition of Abbe, Li and Sly [18, Lemma 3.4] (the second-moment exponent is largest at overlap zero), which they prove for every width in their Section 4.7.1. At fixed $\alpha < \alpha_c^{\mathrm{sym}}(|\kappa|)$ the row count αN is eventually below $\alpha_c^{\mathrm{sym}}(|\kappa|)N - c\log N$, so a symmetric solution of width $|\kappa|$ exists with probability $1 - o(1)$. (The lognormal limit of Abbe, Li, and Sly [18] is proved for Rademacher disorder, and Perkins and Xu [17] treat the Gaussian case under a single-critical-point hypothesis, so neither alone covers the model here.) □

The bound should be read next to monotonicity. A solution at margin 0 is a solution at every $\kappa < 0$, so $m_N(\kappa) \ge m_N(0)$, and at $\kappa = 0$ the ratio $m_N(0)/N$ converges in probability to $\alpha_\star(0) \approx 0.8330786$ (the lower half by [9] with the sharp-threshold transfer of [20], its numerical hypotheses certified in [14]). Hence for $\kappa < 0$

$$\frac{m_N(\kappa)}{N} \;\ge\; \max\bigl\{\alpha_\star(0),\, \alpha_c^{\mathrm{sym}}(|\kappa|)\bigr\} - o(1) \quad \text{with high probability.}$$

At the two certified negative margins monotonicity is the stronger input: the embedding gives 0.215 at $\kappa = -0.05$ and 0.655 at $\kappa = -0.45$, against the predicted 0.889 and 1.558. The embedding takes over only for $\kappa < -0.5757$, where $\alpha_c^{\mathrm{sym}}(|\kappa|)$ passes $\alpha_\star(0)$. Li, Schramm, and Zhou [22] prove lower bounds on the satisfiability threshold of the same one-sided perceptron at negative margin by a different route, with the sharpest statements in the $\kappa \to -\infty$ regime.

8.3 The Ding–Sun condition at general margin

The construction underlying the $\kappa = 0$ lower bound of [9] is written at general margin throughout their Section 2: their equations (34)–(48) define, for parameters $(\kappa_{\mathrm{all}}, \alpha_{\mathrm{all}})$ (their names for the margin and the constraint density), an explicit univariate function $S_{\kappa,\alpha}(\omega)$ on $[\omega_{\min}, 1]$ built from the fixed point $(q_\star, \psi_\star)$ (an entropy term through the two-spin measure $P_{H,D}$, a constraint term through the conditional Mills law φ_ξ, and a convex $\inf_s$ correction), and their Condition 1.2 is the statement $S_{0,\alpha_\star}(\omega) < 0$ for $\omega \notin \{0, 1\}$. The κ-analog of that hypothesis is therefore already defined in their own notation, and its κ-dependent inputs are the fixed point, its uniqueness rectangle and the crossing, which are given by Theorem 5 and the enclosures of Theorem 4.

In floating point, with Gauss–Hermite and conditional Gauss–Legendre quadrature, the function $S_{\kappa,\alpha_\star(\kappa)}$ behaves uniformly at the five certified margins and at $\kappa = 0$ (Figure 2): at every margin the curve is strictly negative off $\{0, 1\}$, at most $-5\cdot 10^{-5}$ outside windows of half-width 0.02 around the two roots (inside them it climbs to its maxima at the roots, reaching $-1.6\cdot 10^{-6}$ at the closest grid points), the maximum at $\omega = 0$ is degenerate exactly as at $\kappa = 0$,

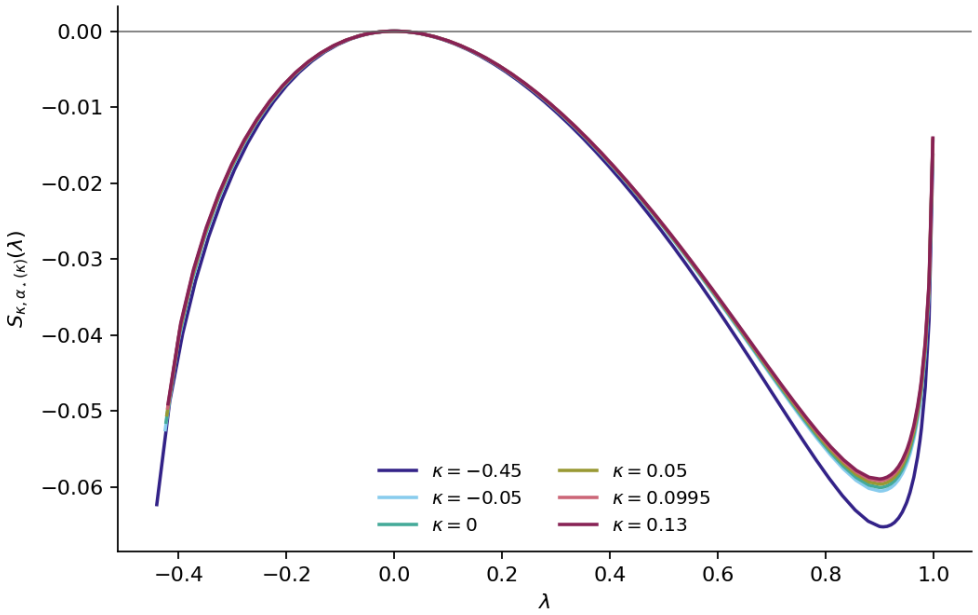


Figure 2: The general-margin Ding–Sun lower-bound condition, evaluated at the five certified margins and $\kappa = 0$: the univariate function $S_{\kappa,\alpha_\star(\kappa)}$ of their equation (48), whose negativity off $\{0, 1\}$ is the numerical hypothesis of their second-moment argument. All six curves are negative off the two roots and nearly coincide.

and the whole family collapses nearly onto a single shape, with $\omega_{\min}$ drifting from -0.441 at $\kappa = -0.45$ to -0.421 at $\kappa = 0.13$. The inequality $S_{\kappa,\alpha_\star(\kappa)}(\omega) < 0$ for $\omega \notin \{0, 1\}$ is not proved at any $\kappa \neq 0$.

What separates these verified inputs from a general-margin lower bound is the probabilistic body of [9]: the AMP-conditioned moment computation of their Sections 2–7, whose displays carry κ_{all} explicitly; by their Remark 1.5 the assumption $\kappa = 0$ enters only in a few steps, which they indicate. Extending that body to $\kappa \neq 0$ requires, beyond the certified inputs above: a priori bounds at margin (the upper one is free at every κ from the first moment, since $\mathbb{E}\mathcal{Z} \to 0$ exponentially above the annealed threshold $-\log 2/\log \Psi(\kappa)$; for $\kappa < 0$ the lower one is the monotonicity bound above), the state-evolution inputs (generic in the nonlinearity, hence in κ), and the sharp-threshold transfer of [20] if convergence in probability rather than positive probability is wanted.

9 What is checked in exact arithmetic

Every inequality of Theorems 4 and 5 is decided by a comparison of arb balls (python-flint 0.9.0 on FLINT 3.6.0), built from the primitives of [14]: monotone endpoint evaluations, mean-value cells, correlated integrands and tail bounds. The identities the certificates use are Lemmas 1, 2 and 3, the formula for ℓ (Section 4.1), the constraint constants C_j (Section 5.1) and the identity written against b_0 (Section 6).

The certificates of Condition 4 record every sign-critical quantity as an outward-rounded

decimal in canonical JSON, bound by SHA-256 hashes; the stage-2 file binds the hash of the Region I file it reads. Their exact layer is restated over the integers and checked by the Lean 4 kernel (core library, v4.35.0): the star-interior inequality chain and the positivity of its perturbation determinant, the positive definiteness of the Loewner majorants $\bar{B}$ at all five margins, and the gap-free tilings of the Region II and stage-2 grids and of the 1404-band Region I schedule. Two global clauses on the band geometry, that the innermost ring closes the full circle and that each level's angular support lies inside the previous level's, together make every radial chain contiguous out to the star radius. These two clauses and the analytic lemmas are not part of the statement checked in Lean.

The enclosures behind Theorem 5 are not restated in exact arithmetic; that theorem rests on the ball-arithmetic computation alone.

10 What the curve says about learning

For binary weights the Euclidean norm is fixed at $\sqrt{N}$, so a margin constraint is a robustness certificate: if $y_a\langle w, x_a\rangle/\sqrt{N} \geq \kappa$, the label y_a is unchanged under every perturbation of x_a of Euclidean norm below κ. With centrally symmetric i.i.d. designs and independent labels, folding the labels into the design makes the event that a binary w stores every label with robustness radius κ the satisfiability event studied here. Theorem 4 at $\kappa = 0.05$ therefore says that for at least $0.781075N$ random labels, with probability tending to one as $N \to \infty$, no binary weight vector stores all of them with robustness radius 0.05.

On the certified strip the logarithm of $\alpha_\star$ decreases at a rate that falls from about 1.55 per unit margin at $\kappa = -0.65$ to about 1.26 near $\kappa = 0.1$ (1.40 on average), so the capacity halves for every 0.45 to 0.55 of demanded radius. In floating point, the ratio $\alpha_\star/\alpha_{\mathrm{sph}}$ grows from 0.417 at $\kappa = 0$ to 0.556 at $\kappa = 1.5$: against real-valued weights, binary weights give up proportionally less storage as the demanded radius grows. The radius is measured in feature space; a statement in input space needs a Lipschitz bound on the feature map.

11 Scope and further directions

Other margins of the same family. The certificates of Section 6 can be run wherever the continuation reaches: positive margins up to $\kappa \approx 1.18$, where $\mathcal{H}$ loses definiteness and a local argument must re-optimize the tilt (Section 5.1), and negative margins until replica symmetry breaks. Toward deep negative margin the weak eigenvalue of $\mathcal{H}$ and the slack in ℓ_0 shrink; whether Condition 4 holds down to the margin where replica symmetry breaks is open.

The lower bound. Ding and Sun's conditioned second-moment argument is carried out at $\kappa = 0$; its hypothesis at general margin is the one-variable inequality $S_{\kappa,\alpha_\star} < 0$ of Section 8, which holds in floating point at the five margins.

Notation

The last column gives the section where the symbol is defined. Symbols used only inside one proof are not listed.

Symbol	Meaning	Section
N	number of binary weights	1
w	weight vector in $\{-1,+1\}^N$	1
g_a	a-th pattern, a standard Gaussian vector in $\mathbb{R}^N$	1
m	number of patterns, $m = \lceil \alpha N \rceil$	1
α	pattern density m/N	1
κ	margin	1
$\varphi,\ \Psi$	standard Gaussian density and upper tail	2
E	inverse Mills ratio φ/Ψ	2
Z	standard Gaussian variable	2
$u(z;q,\kappa)$	$(\kappa - \sqrt{q}\,z)/\sqrt{1-q}$	2
$q,\ \psi$	the two order parameters	2
$P,\ R$	the two halves of the fixed-point map, (1)	2
G	replica-symmetric free energy, (2)	2
$G_\star(\alpha)$	G along the fixed-point branch	2
$\alpha_\star(\kappa)$	the zero of $G_\star$; the predicted capacity	2
$(q_\star,\psi_\star)$	the fixed-point branch as a function of α	2
(q_0,ψ_0)	the fixed point at $\alpha_\star(\kappa)$	2
$\ell(\hat{z}),\ \ell_0$	the local-concavity function of Condition 3 and its minimum	4.1
$\mu(\hat{z})$	$\mathbb{E}[(\hat{z} + \cosh^2(\sqrt{\psi_0}Z))^{-1}]$	4.1
$\tau,\ A,\ \beta$	$E'(u)$, $1-q_0$ and $\mu(\hat{z}) - A$ in the formula for ℓ	4.1
$\mathcal{H}$	Hessian of the two-variable function at $(1,0)$, tilt held at s_0	5.1
η	$E\big((\kappa - \hat{H})/\sqrt{1-q_0}\big)/\sqrt{1-q_0}$	5.1
$\dot{H},\ \hat{H}$	independent Gaussians of variances ψ_0 and q_0	5.2
M	$\tanh \dot{H}$	5.2
Λ	a profile, a function of $\dot{H}$ with values in $[-1,1]$	5.2
$a = (a_1, a_2)$	the moments $(\mathbb{E}[\dot{H}\Lambda], \mathbb{E}[M\Lambda])$	5.2
K	the moment body, the set of attainable a	5.2
$\mathcal{S}(\Lambda, s)$	Huang's two-variable function at tilt s	5.2
$\mathcal{S}_\star(\lambda_1,\lambda_2)$	$\inf_{s\geq 0} \mathcal{S}(\tanh(\lambda_1\dot{H} + \lambda_2 M), s)$	5.2
$\lambda,\ b$	dual points in $\mathbb{R}^2$	5.2
$\Phi(b)$	$\mathbb{E}\log 2\cosh(b_1\dot{H} + b_2 M)$	5.2
$H(a)$	entropy term as a function of the moments	5.2
$a^\star$	$(\psi_0(1-q_0), q_0)$, the moment point of the maximizing profile $\tanh \dot{H}$	5.2
b_0	the dual point $(1,0)$, at which $\nabla\Phi(b_0) = a^\star$	1
s_0	the optimal tilt $\sqrt{1-q_0}$ at $a^\star$	5.2
$\mathcal{F}(a,s)$	upper bound for $\mathcal{S}(\Lambda,s)$ at moment $a(\Lambda) = a$, with the maximal entropy $H(a)$	5
$v,\ c,\ t$	ray direction, tilt slope and distance along the ray	6
$\chi_{v,c}(t)$	$\mathcal{F}(a^\star + tv,\ s_0 + ct)$	6
Δ	$(\lambda_1 - 1)\dot{H} + \lambda_2 M$ in the integrand written against b_0	6

Symbol	Meaning	Section
V, σ	argument of E and $E(V) - V$	Lemma 3
$\bar{B}$	Loewner majorant of $\nabla^2\Phi$ on a Region I band	7
$\alpha_c(\kappa)$	the bound $2/(\pi\mathbb{E}[(\kappa - Z)_+^2])$ of Nakajima's uniqueness theorem	4.3
$\alpha_{\mathrm{sph}}(\kappa)$	spherical capacity $1/\mathbb{E}[(\kappa - Z)_+^2]$	3
$\mathcal{Z}$	number of solutions at margin κ	8
$\varpi_\rho(\kappa)$	$\mathbb{P}(X \geq \kappa, Y \geq \kappa)$, correlation ρ	8
$\alpha_c^{\mathrm{sym}}(r)$	symmetric binary perceptron threshold at width r	8
slab	a κ interval of width $5 \cdot 10^{-4}$ with its rectangle	4
rectangle, box	products of intervals in (α, q), and in (q_0, ψ_0)	4
sub-slab	one of eight κ intervals of width $6.25 \cdot 10^{-5}$ covering a slab	4
per-slab $\alpha_\star$ interval	the $\alpha_\star$ enclosure of one slab	2
deep $\alpha_\star$ interval	an $\alpha_\star$ enclosure of width about $2 \cdot 10^{-6}$ at one margin	4
exclusion region	a product of two intervals about $a^\star$ that contains the star	6
enclosure of $a^\star$	the image of the box under $(q_0, \psi_0) \mapsto (\psi_0(1 - q_0), q_0)$	6
dual enclosure	a certified region of the dual plane containing the dual maximizers	6
leaves	the certified pieces of a bisected sweep cell	6
weak direction	the line through $a^\star$ along an eigenvector of the Hessian of $\bar{\mathcal{S}}$ at $a^\star$, eigenvalue nearest 0	6
supplementary arcs	angular ranges with a ray certificate beyond the main radius	6
star	the star-shaped neighborhood of $a^\star$ of the ray certificates	6
Region I, II, stage 2	the ray certificates on the star; the sweep of K outside the exclusion region; the sweep of the exclusion region minus the star	6
$m_N(\kappa)$	largest m for which a solution exists	8
$S_{\kappa,\alpha}(\omega)$	Ding and Sun's univariate function on $[\omega_{\min}, 1]$	8

Acknowledgements and funding

The author acknowledges support from the European Research Council under the European Union's Horizon Europe program (grant 101041711), the Simons Foundation, Heights Labs, Convex Nexus Capital, and Israel Science Foundation grants 2258/19 and 4101/25. Computational resources were provided in part by Google Cloud through its education credits program (credit 530550103).

Declaration of competing interest

The author holds equity in Heights Labs and in Convex Nexus Capital and has a management role at Convex Nexus Capital.

Declaration of generative AI and AI-assisted technologies

The mathematics, the software, the certificates and the drafting of this paper were done by AI agents, Claude (Anthropic) and Codex (OpenAI), working through the shared memory of the Math Brain project: its code and tests [23], the framework it runs on [25] and its description [24]. The author set the objective, supervised the runs, reviewed the mathematics and accepts responsibility for the paper.

Data availability

No external data were used. The verification programs, certificates and raw records are available at `https://github.com/yspennstate/ising-perceptron-margin/tree/v2.0`, with the certificates in the folder `verification/results`.

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